Publicly averse to giving Najibullah asylum in India, Ahamed's conciliatory advocacy had little to do with his Islamic credentials. 'It is proved beyond any shadow of doubt that those who ruled Afghanistan were puppets in the hands of the Soviet Union Government ... there are writings on the wall when we deal with Afghanistan. We must strive hard to maintain the best friendship with Afghanistan', implored Ahamed.[66] Similarly, B. Vijaykumar Raju of the Telugu Desam Party from Andhra Pradesh, despite being wary of Pakistan's dominance in Afghanistan, concurred with Rao. On 3 May 1992, the BJP National Council passed a resolution endorsing Rao's decision on Afghanistan. BJP MP Jaswant Singh, a foreign affairs expert who would become India's powerful external affairs and defence minister in 1998, argued that the government should cautiously, but surely, move ahead with its opening up to the Mujahideen.[67] Despite the rise of violent Hindu nationalism in early 1990s (the Babri Masjid Demolition took place in December 1992), Jaswant Singh was able to lobby the BJP along conciliatory lines.[68]

This was an achievement given the fact that just two days before such a statement, various members of the BJP National Council had raised apprehensions about the Mujahideen's Islamist credentials, influence of Pakistan on the latter, and how such Pakistani influence might lead to the Mujahideen supporting Kashmiri and Khalistani separatists.[69] The BJP, however, gave Afghanistan the benefit of the doubt politically as it was unclear whether it would adopt the Iranian, Iraqi, or Turkish model of dealing with religion and matters of state. Najibullah's fall, nonetheless, was greeted as good news. The BJP declared that Najibullah's fall brought an end to the suffering of Afghan people for the previous fourteen tortuous years, and in light of this news India should ensure friendly relations with whosoever came to power in Kabul.[70] Other MPs from the Bihar Congress, such as Chandresh P Thakur, also actively advocated that the government should work with other 'middle powers' to build a concrete international consensus against big-power intervention and open dialogue with all entities on the ground.[71]

The *Times of India*, which had been partly critical of India's heavy tilt towards Najibullah, had also become harsher in its criticism by 1989. One of its columns carried a blunt piece titled 'India cannot gain by ignoring the Mujahideen', in